



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

NPCJ Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating Procedures

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1. Introduction

Upholding academic integrity is fundamental to maintaining the quality and credibility of education and research. The National Police College of Jamaica, as the regional institution of choice for excellence in law enforcement education, training and development is committed to fostering a culture of honesty, integrity, and ethical conduct among its students, faculty, and staff.

This *Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating Procedures* outlines the standards and expectations regarding academic integrity within the National Police College of Jamaica. The policy conforms to national and international standards of educational certification and accreditation bodies. The guidelines, protocols, and directions communicated are in keeping with laws, regulations, Force Orders, and best known practices. Students, Faculty and Staff are required to read, and comply with the policy and SOPs.

2. Purpose

The purpose of the *Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating Procedures* is to further the aim of the NPCJ to prevent and address all forms of academic misconduct, and academic dishonesty including but not limited to data falsification, collusion, and unauthorized collaboration.

3. Scope

This *Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating Procedures* applies to all staff, faculty and students of the NPCJ including sworn and unsworn members of the JCF and its auxiliary; and non-JCF members and staff. It applies to all programs, courses and other training activities conducted at a JCF facility, or under its supervision or direction including where the JCF is a contractor.

4. Abbreviations and Acronyms

ACP Assistant Commissioner of Police
DCP Deputy Commissioner of Police
JCF Jamaica Constabulary Force
MAC Management Advisory Committee

5. Definitions

- 5.1. **Academic Misconduct, or Academic Dishonesty:** Any action or behaviour that violates the principles of academic integrity, including but not limited to plagiarism, cheating, fabrication of data, collusion, unauthorized collaboration, and any other forms of dishonesty in academic work.
- 5.2. **Plagiarism:** Presenting someone else's ideas, words, or work as one's own; or self-plagiarism (text-recycling or duplicate publication) without proper citation or acknowledgment.
- 5.3. **Cheating:** Using unauthorized materials, methods, or assistance to complete academic work, examinations, or assessments.
- 5.4. **Fabrication of Data:** Falsification or invention of data, results, or sources in academic work or research.
- 5.5. **Collusion:** Unauthorized collaboration with others in academic work or assessments, where individual work is expected.
- 5.6. **Unauthorized Collaboration:** Working with others without proper authorization or acknowledgment in individual assignments, projects, or assessments.
- 5.7. **Training Record:** documented record or log that contains information related to an individual's training activities and accomplishments including the type of training undertaken, the duration, the date(s) attended, the topics covered, the trainer or training provider, any certifications or qualifications obtained, and any assessments or evaluations completed.

6. Responsibilities

The following summarizes key responsibilities:

Generally, the following conduct is prohibited for all members of the NPCJ pracademic community:

Students

- 1.1. Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity in all their academic endeavours.
- 1.2. Students must familiarize themselves with this Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating Procedures, and abide by its provisions.
- 1.3. Students must complete all assignments, examinations, and assessments honestly and independently, unless explicitly authorized to collaborate.

Faculty and Staff

- 1.4. Faculty and staff are responsible for educating students about academic integrity and promoting a culture of honesty and integrity.
- 1.5. Faculty and staff must ensure that all academic assessments and evaluations are conducted fairly and without bias.
- 1.6. Faculty and staff must promptly report any suspected cases of academic misconduct to the appropriate authorities for investigation and resolution.

Registrar (through the Assistant Registrar, Assessments)

- 1.7. The Registrar is responsible for enforcing this Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating procedures and ensuring compliance with certification and accreditation standards.
- 1.8. The Registrar must provide adequate support and resources to educate students and faculty about academic integrity and prevent misconduct.
- 1.9. The Registrar must establish procedures for investigating and adjudicating cases of academic misconduct in a fair and impartial manner.

7. Policy Statement

As a community of academics, the NPCJ values honesty, fairness, and respect for intellectual property. It is the policy of the NPCJ that all students, faculty and staff shall partake in maintaining a culture of ethical conduct, adhering to the principles of academic integrity in all academic activities, including teaching, learning, research, and scholarly communication.

8. Prohibited Conduct

- 8.1. Falsification of professional or academic credentials – Students or faculty proffering inaccurate or unverifiable information on their educational and professional background. A student admitted to the University on the basis of false credentials is subject to sanctions up to and including disenrollment.
- 8.2. Plagiarism - Plagiarism in any form is strictly prohibited. This includes presenting, whether intentionally or not, the ideas, expression of ideas or work of others as one's own without proper citation, paraphrasing without attribution, and self-plagiarism. Specifically, this can include, but is not limited to:
 - 8.2.1. Reproducing or paraphrasing portions of someone else's published or unpublished material, regardless of the source, and presenting these as one's own without proper citation or reference to the original source;
 - 8.2.2. Submitting a take-home examination, essay, technical report or other assignment written, in whole or in part, by someone else;
 - 8.2.3. Using ideas or direct quotations, or paraphrased material, concepts, or ideas without appropriate acknowledgment in any academic assignment;
 - 8.2.4. Using another's data or research findings;
 - 8.2.5. Failing to acknowledge sources through the use of proper citations when using another's work and/or failing to use quotation marks;
 - 8.2.6. Using information from the internet, a web page, or a government publication without giving credit by means of a footnote/endnote, and
 - 8.2.7. Handing in substantially the same piece of work for academic credit more than once without prior written permission of the course instructor in which the submission occurs.

8.3. Cheating - Cheating by knowingly using, or attempting to use prohibited course-related material for an examination, quizzes, tests, or any other form of assessment is prohibited. Possession of such unauthorised material is interpreted as intent to cheat or to facilitate cheating. Cheating includes, but is not limited to:

8.3.1. Copying another person's work, either in an examination or take-home assignment, with the intent of submitting same one's own work;

8.3.2. Having someone else prepare or complete an assignment or part thereof that will be submitted as own work, whether or not for compensation. Proof-reading by another person is not considered cheating;

8.3.3. Having prohibited knowledge of examination instruments or of the mark scheme or prohibited assistance, in print or otherwise, for an examination prior to the sitting of the examination;

8.3.4. Possession of a prohibited device used to obtain assistance (calculator, cell phone, text messaging, among other things) during an examination;

8.3.5. Impersonation such as sitting an examination on behalf of another person;

8.3.6. Working on an examination or other assessment exercise outside the specified time limits, such as beginning before the invigilator directs students to begin, or continuing to work after the invigilator has declared an end to the examination period;

8.3.7. Modifying a student's response on an examination script – deleting, adding, substituting and the like - or facilitating same.

8.4. Fabrication of Data - Fabricating, falsifying, or misrepresenting data, results, or sources in academic work, research, or reports is prohibited. Fabrication of data includes, but is not limited to:

8.4.1. Deliberate misrepresentation in reporting the method used for data collection;

8.4.2. Altering or attempting to alter without authorization the contents of a grade sheet, progress report, transcript, or any other type of academic report, whether unofficial or official;

8.4.3. Altering or attempting to alter the contents of any official document, such as a status letter, award certificate, or exam permit;

8.4.4. Any other effort to deceive or mislead using the contents of an academic or research submission or that of an academic record.

8.5. Collusion and Unauthorized Collaboration - Collusion, which involves unauthorized collaboration with others in academic work or assessments, is prohibited. Unless explicitly stated otherwise, students are to assume that each assignment is individual work. Where a piece of work was a product of collaboration, all persons who contributed to its completion are to be clearly acknowledged in writing. Colluding includes, but is not limited to:

8.5.1. Unauthorized communication during an examination or coursework piece;

8.5.2. Collaboration with other students to submit the same or similar piece of work for assessment. All students will be seen as having colluded and each shall be subject to penalties;

8.5.3. Including a person's name on an assignment or article, knowing that they did not contribute to the production of the piece of work;

8.5.4. Distributing sensitive course assessment materials (e.g. Online exams, class tests, previously completed assignments to be copied whether or not for sale;

8.5.5. Facilitating another student committing a violation of the academic integrity policy.

9. Standard Operating Procedures

All reports of academic dishonesty within the NPCJ shall be treated in accordance with the following:

10. Reports and Investigations

Any member of the NPCJ community who suspects a breach of the Policy on Academic Integrity should report the offence to the Head of Faculty or Department immediately.

Where the misconduct occurs in the sitting of an examination, the invigilator shall allow the candidate to complete the examination. A notation is to be made on the candidate's script upon collection and the matter reported to the Assistant Registrar, Assessments who shall invite the candidate's immediate response, and give notice to the Head of Faculty or Department.

The Head of Faculty or Department, or Assistant Registrar, Assessments shall investigate the report in a fair, impartial, and confidential manner, respecting the rights of all parties involved, and make a determination of whether a violation of the Policy on Academic Integrity has occurred.

The head of faculty or department, or Assistant Registrar, Assessments shall:

- 1.9.1. Secure all evidence of the violation
- 1.9.2. Promptly notify the student. Where collusion is suspected, all students shall be independently notified.
- 1.9.3. Schedule a meeting with the student no later than seven (7) work days after the discovery of evidence.
- 1.9.4. A neutral party to the allegations is to be invited to silently observe and witness the meeting.

During this initial meeting:

- 1.9.5. The head of faculty or department will describe the alleged actions or items in evidence that raise suspicion of academic misconduct.
- 1.9.6. The student(s) shall have an opportunity to respond to the allegations.
- 1.9.7. If a student presents sufficient evidence in denial of the accusation at the meeting, the matter shall be closed and no report or record made.

11. Hearings

If the Head of Faculty or Department determines that the severity, repetition of violation, or other factor(s) warrants the convening of a panel hearing he shall request the convening of the Assessment and Examinations Committee, through the Assistant Registrar, Assessments and the student(s) shall be notified of the referral of the case.

12. Penalties

Violations by students - Any student of the community found to have committed plagiarism will be subject to the following consequences:

12.1. First Offence:

- 12.1.1. The participant will receive a failing grade for the assignment.
- 12.1.2. The participant will be required to attend a citation workshop by the NPCJ Library.
- 12.1.3. The participant's individual report will reflect the offence.

12.2. Second Offence:

- 12.2.1. The participant will receive a failing grade for the course.
- 12.2.2. The participant will be suspended from the NPCJ for one semester, course or programme, depending on the discretion of the head of Faculty and the Director of NPCJ.
- 12.2.3. The participant's individual report and transcript will reflect the offence.

12.3. Members of the JCF may be subject to additional departmental disciplinary actions provided for under the JCF Book of Rules.

12.4. Students shall be notified in writing of any penalty imposed, and a copy placed on the student's academic file.

Violations by faculty or staff - Staff and faculty of NPCJ guilty of academic misconduct as registered students of the College will be treated as students. In their capacity as 'employees' should there be any academic misconduct or violations of academic integrity as covered in this and/or other policies of college, or any other related official legislative, procedural or operational guidelines of this institution, the offending faculty or staff member shall be referred to the relevant supervisory or regulatory authority for a determination on sanctions.

13. Appeal Process

- 13.1. Students found guilty of academic misconduct have the right to appeal the decision through submitting a request in writing within seven (7) days of being notified to the Assistant Registrar, Assessments who shall arrange for a review of the case to take place by the Academic Board within seven (7) days of the student's application for an appeal.
- 13.2. Where the Academic Board finds that there is no basis penalty applied, it shall, in writing, advise the relevant persons to revoke the actions and remove any notations from the student's file and records
- 13.3. Where the Academic Board finds that the penalty is appropriate, it shall notify the student through the Office of the Student Registrar that the decision of the lower authority is upheld.
- 13.4. Where the Academic Board finds that the penalty is too severe for the violation, it shall direct the relevant authority to reduce the penalty, prescribing what the reduction should be.
- 13.5. Where the Academic Board finds that the penalty is too lenient for the violation, it shall direct the relevant authority to increase the penalty or substitute with a more stringent penalty.

14. Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

This Policy on Academic Integrity shall be read in conjunction with the Jamaica's Copyright Act 1993; Jamaica Copyright Amendment Act 2015; the JCF Training Policy and Procedures, NPCJ Student Handbook, NPCJ Quality Assessment Policy, NPCJ Student Code of Conduct, and programme and course outlines.

15. Educational Initiatives

The NPCJ will provide educational initiatives to promote academic integrity and prevent misconduct. These initiatives may include workshops, seminars, online resources, and academic integrity tutorials.

16. Review and Revision

The NPCJ is committed to maintaining the highest standards of academic integrity and ethical conduct. This Policy on Academic Integrity and Standard Operating Procedures will be reviewed periodically to ensure its effectiveness and relevance. Any necessary revisions will be made in consultation with relevant stakeholders, including students, faculty, staff, academic/advisory boards, and certification and accreditation bodies.